asked him where he was from. Though the JCO was from Etawah, for some inexplicable reason he managed to whisper that he was from Allahabad. The nurse looked at him for just a few extra seconds and then marked him as a hopeful case. The execution party following behind her accordingly bypassed Dashrath.

Strange are the ways of war. The Chinese woman who had decided that his other seriously wounded comrades could not be saved now became Dashrath's guardian angel. Every time the valiant subedar came to, she was right next to him. From the banks of the Nam Ka Chu the surviving Indians were herded across the Thagla Ridge into Tibet. There, Chinese doctors performed a near miracle, pulling Dashrath Singh from the Danger List to the Critical List, no mean feat when it came to a man who had more than two dozen bullets in his stomach and a collapsed lung. At some point during his recovery, the nurse told Dashrath Singh why she had chosen to save him over the others. It turned out that she had done her nursing training in India, which explained her fluency in Hindi. What she said next almost took the wind out of Dashrath's other lung—the city she had studied in and fallen in love with was Allahabad.

The Chinese nurse would stay by Dashrath's side until he was handed over to Indian doctors at Bum-la where the wounded and the captured men were subsequently repatriated. The officers were separately sent back to Calcutta by air. Even after the formalities were completed and the men handed over, she sought out the Indian doctors so she could explain to them how to keep Dashrath's collapsed lung ballooned. She then turned and was the last to go over the heap of stones that marked the boundary between India and China.